

# Arda Link — Mom Test Field Kit

v1.0 · Isiolo County · 10 pastoralist interviews + 5 ecosystem informants

*Get out of the building. Validate the problem before we polish the product.*

**Version 1.0 · Isiolo County · 10 pastoralist interviews + 5 ecosystem informants**

## 0. How to use this kit

This kit exists for one job: to find out whether the problem we think we are solving is the problem a pastoralist in Isiolo actually has — in his words, with his numbers — and to find out who the users, the beneficiaries and the payers are. Everything else (polish, features, model tuning) is cheaper after this round than before it.

It is **not** a survey, not a sales visit, and not a demo. If we leave an interview having explained our product and collected compliments, the interview failed. If we leave with dates, amounts, distances, names and a story about a specific day last season, it worked.

### What happens in this round

| # | Step                                   | Who                                                 | Output                                            |
|---|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Talk</b> (Mom Test, 40–60 min each) | 10 pastoralists, in their place                     | Their problem, their numbers, their words         |
| 2 | <b>Watch</b> (usability, unaided)      | the same 10                                         | Where the service loses them                      |
| 3 | <b>Ask for something</b> (commitment)  | the same 10                                         | Callback, introduction, a test at the water point |
| 4 | <b>Ask the ecosystem</b> (20–30 min)   | agroveter, county vet, chief, water committee, NDMA | Who decides, who pays, who can block              |

### The one-page version of the whole kit

| What we want to know                                                    | How we find out                                              | Evidence that counts                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Is the water/grazing decision frequent, hard and expensive?             | Ask for the last three times it went wrong                   | A story with a place, a month, and a cost       |
| Is information the binding constraint — not money, not water, not land? | Ask what he did, what he paid, how far he walked to find out | Money, hours, km, animals lost, litres of milk  |
| Will he use WhatsApp and give one tap back?                             | Watch him use it, then ask for a commitment                  | He completes a task unaided; he reports once    |
| Does our data survive his own knowledge?                                | Have him check our message, our map, our kg estimate         | He confirms or corrects us, with his own number |
| Who benefits, and who pays?                                             | Household questions + ecosystem informants                   | A real past payment, or a named budget line     |

## 1. The rules of the conversation (Mom Test)

Read these in the vehicle. They are the difference between learning something and being lied to politely.

1. **Talk about his life, not our idea.** Nobody tells you your baby is ugly — especially not a courteous host in his own manyatta.
2. **Ask about the past, never the future.** "Would you use this?" detects nothing. "When did you last have to decide where to move?" is data.
3. **Ask for stories, not opinions.** The moment he says "usually" or "I think", go back to "tell me about the last time".
4. **Numbers or it did not happen.** How many animals, how many days, how many shillings, how many kilometres, which month.
5. **Compliments are junk food.** "That is a good idea" means nothing. Thank him, and return to facts.
6. **Money questions are about the past.** Not "would you pay 50 bob?" but "when did you last pay money for advice or information — to whom, how much?"
7. **Never pitch.** If you are talking about our product for more than 30 seconds, you are not learning. One line, then straight back to his last season.
8. **Ask for something specific at the end.** Time (a callback), reputation (an introduction), a test. That is the only part of the conversation that is not free, and therefore the only part that proves anything.

### Three phrases that kill an interview

| Do not say           | Say instead                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| "Would you..."       | "When did you last..."           |
| "Do you think..."    | "What did you do..."             |
| "We are building..." | "Tell me more about that day..." |

If he asks "what are you building?" — one line, then back:

*"We are testing whether a phone can help with water and grazing decisions. But I would rather hear about your last dry season than talk about it. Can we go back to that?"*

**Two of us at most:** one talks, one writes. The writer captures verbatim quotes, numbers and place names — never interpretations. Paper, not a phone: a phone in your hand reads as a distraction or a survey.

## 2. Who we are testing: users vs beneficiaries vs payers

Fill the empty cells as you go. The empty cells are the point of the round — most of these are currently **our assumption**, not a fact. If a "can they pay" or "can they block" column is still blank at the end, we have a feature, not a service.

| Role                           | Who (Isiolo)                                           | What they want                               | What it costs them today               | How they would use Arda Link                     | Can pay?                          | Can block?                         |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| User — decision maker          | Herd owner (usually an older man)                      | Not to lose animals; to know where to move   | Wasted walks, dead animals, milk drop  | Decides movement; may never hold the phone       | Owns the animals = the asset base | Yes — if he ignores it, it is dead |
| User — the one who is there    | Young herder (moran/youth) who takes animals out daily | Water today, no wasted walking               | Hours, km, heat                        | Highest one-tap compliance; reports status       | Rarely                            | No                                 |
| User + primary beneficiary     | Woman in the manyatta (milk, water, shoats)            | Milk, children's food, water, milk price     | Walks to water, milk loss, sick shoats | Receives voice notes; reports water and queue    | Sometimes — milk money            | Yes, quietly                       |
| Beneficiary                    | Household, children, elderly                           | Food, milk, income stability                 | Nutrition when herds fail              | Indirectly                                       | No                                | No                                 |
| Gatekeeper + beneficiary       | Water point committee / WRUA                           | A working point, no fights at the trough     | Queue conflict, breakdowns             | Fans status out to members                       | Maybe — a small fund              | Yes                                |
| Channel + trust anchor         | Agrovet                                                | Footfall, correct drug use                   | Wrong products bought, no follow-up    | Distributes the number; answers health questions | Yes — a business                  | Yes                                |
| Authority + content review     | County vet / sub-county livestock officer              | Surveillance, fewer outbreaks                | No ground-level data                   | Reviews our pest and health wording              | Yes — county budget               | Yes                                |
| Distribution                   | Chief / assistant chief / ward admin                   | Order, service delivery, being seen to help  | Nothing                                | Baraza announcement, signboard at the point      | No                                | Yes                                |
| Data partner + payer candidate | NDMA ward officer / drought monitoring                 | Ward-level ground truth on water and pasture | Thin, late ground truth                | Reads or buys the water-report stream            | Possibly — a monitoring line      | Yes                                |
| Payer candidates               | NGO/CBO projects, county, insurer                      | Reach, M&E, underwriting data                | Expensive last-mile data collection    | White-label our stream                           | Possibly                          | —                                  |
| Us                             | Arda Link                                              | A service that survives the field            | —                                      | —                                                | —                                 | —                                  |

**The uncomfortable question this round must answer:** today **nobody is the buyer** — not the herder, not the county, not an insurer. If the round does not surface a real past payment or a real budget line, we do not have revenue, we have a donor project.

Pair this with the **decision-rights** question, because it decides the whole channel:

| Decision                                | Who actually decides | Who influences | Who must not be bypassed |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|--------------------------|
| When and where to move the herd         |                      |                |                          |
| Which animal to sell                    |                      |                |                          |
| Whether to buy drugs, and which         |                      |                |                          |
| How much to spend on water or transport |                      |                |                          |
| Who gets a phone / airtime / data       |                      |                |                          |

## 3. The sample: 10 pastoralists (plus 5 informants)

Ten is not a statistical sample. It is enough to see the repeated problem — and it is deliberately skewed towards the people our design must not silently exclude.

**Screening (facts only, 3 minutes, before booking the interview)**

1. Do you keep livestock now? Which kind, and roughly how many?
2. When you last decided where to take them, who decided — you, or someone else?
3. Do you have a phone? Who uses it — you alone, or the household? Does it have WhatsApp?
4. How long does the walk to your usual water point take on the day you go?

5. In the last 12 months, did you lose animals, or have a bad tick or worm problem?

**Quotas for the 10** (adjust the numbers to the ward's reality, but keep the spread)

| Must include                                               | Why it matters                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>3 women</b> (at least 2 keeping milking cows or shoats) | Beneficiaries are not the same as users; women's answers differ and are usually not asked |
| <b>3 farthest from water</b> (longest walk)                | Where the problem is most expensive, and where our walk-distance claim is testable        |
| <b>2 recently moved, or mid-move</b>                       | The decision is live — highest signal of the whole round                                  |
| <b>2 camel keepers</b>                                     | Different species, different movement logic, different water rules                        |
| <b>3 shoats-only or shoats-dominant</b>                    | The near-home herd: the woman's herd and the quick money                                  |
| <b>4 cattle-dominant</b>                                   | The classic case                                                                          |
| <b>2 daily WhatsApp users</b>                              | Feasibility of the channel                                                                |
| <b>2 who never use WhatsApp</b> (voice or SMS only)        | The users a channel-only design drops without noticing                                    |
| <b>2 who share a phone with the household</b>              | The "who actually receives the message" problem                                           |
| <b>1–2 whose animal-health event went badly</b>            | Tests the pest loop honestly, not optimistically                                          |
| <b>≥2 wards, ≥3 different water points</b>                 | Stops one point's politics pretending to be a market                                      |
| <b>not</b> our 3 existing registered herders               | They already bought in; they cannot tell us about adoption                                |

**Ecosystem informants (5 × 20–30 min):** one agrovet, one county vet or sub-county livestock officer, one chief/assistant chief, one water point committee member, one NDMA ward officer or CBO project officer. Guides in Appendix D.

**Recruitment:** through the chief, the agrovet and the water committee — then **snowball:** end every interview with *"who else should I talk to — and who would disagree with you?"* The dissenter is worth three agreeable friends.

**Payment:** do **not** pay for an interview. Tea or a soda, yes. Transport reimbursement only if he genuinely travelled to meet us. Never offer airtime for answers: it buys polite answers, which are worse than no data. Airtime is a *pilot* incentive later, and it must be documented as one.

## 4. The interview guide (40–60 minutes)

After every block there is a **Listen for** line: that is what counts as evidence. And an **Avoid** line: that is the trap that fills notebooks with nothing.

### A. Warm-up: a normal day (5 min)

1. Tell me about yesterday — from when you woke up to when you slept. What did you do?
2. Who was with the animals yesterday? Where did they go?
3. Who else lives in your manyatta, and who does what in the day?

**Listen for:** the real division of labour — who is near the water, who holds the phone, who milks, who decides. Most of our assumptions about "the user" die here. **Avoid:** talking about "your herd" as if one person does everything.

### B. The last hard decision (10 min) — the core of the interview

1. Tell me about the last time you moved the animals to a new place. Which month was it? What made you decide?
2. Who did you talk to before you moved? What did each of them say?
3. How long did it take you to decide — from the first thought to the day you moved?
4. What was the first thing you tried, before moving?
5. What did the move cost you — money, animals, days, relationships?
6. Was there a moment when you almost went somewhere else? Why didn't you?

**Listen for:** a chronology with a month and a place name; the number of people consulted (that is our real competition); the cost (that is the size of the problem). **Avoid:** "Was that decision difficult?" He will agree with you. Ask what he did.

### C. Water: the last time it went wrong (10 min)

1. Tell me about the last time you walked to water and there was little or nothing. Which point, which month, how long did you walk?
2. What did you do that day? Did you go somewhere else — how far?
3. What did that day cost you: hours, money, fuel, animals, tempers?
4. Is there a point you stopped going to? Why?
5. Who tells you whether a point is working, or has a long queue? How do you find out?
6. Have you ever paid someone for information about water? What happened?

**Listen for:** a specific day, a distance, a duration, a queue, a breakdown, and a workaround (phoning someone, sending a boy ahead, waiting, going anyway). Every workaround is evidence that the problem is real and currently unsolved.

#### D. Grazing and pasture (10 min)

1. When did the grass near your water last run out? Which month?
2. How did you know it was finished — who saw it, and what did they see?
3. What did you do next? Who suggested it? Did it work?
4. How many animals did you lose, or how much milk did you lose, in that period?
5. Does anyone tell you in advance where the grass is still good? Who, and how often?
6. Have you ever paid for news about pasture — a phone call, transport to go and look, a gift to someone?

**Listen for:** the sequence *grass finished* → *I asked X* → *I went* → *it was good/bad*. That sequence **is** our product today, done by word of mouth and by walking.

#### E. Animal health, ticks and worms (8 min)

1. Tell me about the last time you found ticks or worms in your animals. Which month?
2. What did you do first? Who did you ask?
3. What did you buy, from whom, and how much did it cost? Did it work?
4. Who told you to look at the animals — or did you just see it yourself?
5. If you had been told a week earlier that tick conditions were forming, what would you have done differently? Be specific: what did you do last time?

**Listen for:** whether he *looks* on a rhythm or only when something is visibly wrong — that is precisely the gap the check-first loop fills — and the money spent on drugs, which is the loss we would be reducing. **Avoid:** any animal-health advice. We do not diagnose in the field; that is the vet's and the agroveter's role. If he asks, refer him, and note that he asked.

#### F. Where information actually comes from today (8 min)

1. Where do you get news about rain and grazing? Radio, chief, neighbours, the clinic, a WhatsApp group, the vet? Which one first?
2. Which of those has ever been wrong in a way that cost you something? What happened?
3. What did you believe last week that turned out to be wrong? How did you find out?
4. How much do you spend in a normal month on airtime and data? What do you use it for?
5. Are you in a WhatsApp group with other herders? How many? What is it called? Who forwards to whom? (If he offers to show you, look.)

**Listen for:** the incumbent (chief, radio, neighbour), the cost of finding out, and the forwarding graph. That graph is our distribution channel and our acquisition cost.

#### G. The phone in his hands (5 min)

1. Whose phone is this? How many SIM cards? Who else uses it?
2. When did you last have no network where you keep animals? How long did it last?
3. How do you charge it? What happens when the battery dies?
4. Can you read comfortably on it? Do you read messages, or do you play voice notes?
5. Show me what you do when you get a message you do not understand. (Watch. Do not help.)

**Listen for:** shared phones, dead spots, charging, and voice-versus-text. If he only plays voice notes, every text-only feature we ship is invisible to him.

#### H. Money (8 min) — past spending only

1. What did you spend on your animals in the last month — drugs, water, transport, feed, a vet? Roughly how much of that was cash?
2. When you need 5,000 shillings quickly, what do you sell, or who do you call?
3. Have you ever subscribed to something on your phone — a data bundle, an SMS service, betting? How much per month?
4. Have you ever paid for advice — a vet, an agroveter, a broker, a transporter? When, how much, to whom — and was it worth it?
5. If a phone service kept water and grazing news coming, who around here normally pays for something like that? (Open question. Never "would you pay 50 bob?")

**Listen for:** real amounts for real things — drugs, transport, airtime, water fees. That is the only valid willingness-to-pay evidence, and it lives in the past tense.

### I. Trust, blame and failure (5 min)

1. Tell me about a time when advice about your animals or the rain turned out to be wrong. What did you do about it?
2. If a phone told you the rain would come in five days and it did not come, what would you do with that phone?
3. Who would you believe about rain: the chief, the radio, the vet, a neighbour, or a message on your phone? Why?
4. What would make you stop trusting a service like this completely?
5. If a service said "we do not know" about something, is that better or worse than a guess?

**Listen for:** his tolerance for uncertainty, and the named authority we are compared to. Question 46 is the honesty test — the whole design depends on the answer.

### J. Have others tried? (3 min)

1. Which organisations have given you information or services like this before — an NGO, the county, radio, church, insurance? What happened? Is it still running?
2. Why do you think it stopped — or what would have made you keep using it?

**Listen for:** the graveyard of previous attempts, and why they died. Usually: no rhythm, no reply, no trust, or the project ended.

### K. Household and beneficiary — ask the women separately (5 min)

1. When you get news early — about water, grass or rain — who in the household benefits first, and what do they get?
2. Who fetches water and waters the small stock? How does the walking change with the seasons?
3. Who decides what happens to the small stock and the milk money?
4. What would change in your house if you never wasted a single walk for water this year? What would that be worth to you?

**Listen for:** the beneficiary chain — milk, children, women's time — and whether the value lands where we claim it does.

### L. Close: ask for something (5 min)

1. May I come back or call you in two weeks with what we learned? (*time*)
2. Would you show me your phone and let me send one message to this service from your number, now, while I watch? (*micro-commitment + an unaided attempt*)
3. Who else should I talk to — and who would disagree with you? (*introductions*)
4. Could we do a test at your water point with the committee or the group? (*advancement*)
5. What did I get wrong today? What should I have asked you and did not?

**Listen for:** a yes with a constraint is better than an enthusiastic "yes, definitely" with nothing attached. No introduction, no callback, no test = no signal.

## 5. Watch, do not talk: the product tests during the visit

Talking gives us the problem. **Watching gives us the product.** Run these on the live service — on his phone where possible — with no coaching. Record the outcome and one verbatim reaction for each.

| #  | Test                   | How to run it                                                                                                                                                   | Record                                                                            | What failure would mean                                              |
|----|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| T1 | <b>Unaided find</b>    | Hand him the phone: "find out whether the water at your point is working." Nothing else. 5 min max                                                              | Completed / partial / failed; seconds; where he went wrong; voice or text         | The menu and wording lose the least literate users first             |
| T2 | <b>Comprehension</b>   | Show the real messages (water line, pest window, MALISHO YA LEO, weekly note): "what does this say? what would you do?"                                         | Items he misreads, in his own words; numbers he repeats wrongly                   | Our careful wording fails in the field even when it passes our tests |
| T3 | <b>One tap back</b>    | Ask him to report the status of the point he is standing at, now                                                                                                | Did he complete it; did he refuse; did he ask what he gains                       | The reciprocity loop is the engine — if he will not tap, re-plan     |
| T4 | <b>Voice vs text</b>   | Send the same content both ways; ask which he would rather get at 6am; note which he opens first                                                                | His choice and reason; whether the voice note plays at all on his phone           | A voice-first user base served text-only                             |
| #  | Test                   | How to run it                                                                                                                                                   | Record                                                                            | What failure would mean                                              |
| T5 | <b>The map</b>         | Show the rendered map/paper copy: can he find his manyatta, the point, the direction? What do the date stamp and the word "kadirio" mean to him?                | Whether the place names match what he calls them; whether he trusts the age stamp | Our riskiest artefact: a map that misleads is worse than no map      |
| T6 | <b>The kg question</b> | Does he own, borrow, or know a scale (market, vet)? What real weight does he know for one animal? Would he walk to a scale day? What would he use a weight for? | A reference weight we can check against; his own words for what a weight is worth | Without a reference weight, the weight output stays shadow-only      |

| #  | Test                         | How to run it                                                   | Record                                               | What failure would mean                   |
|----|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| T7 | <b>Uncertainty tolerance</b> | "If we say rain in five days and it does not come — what then?" | Whether honest uncertainty costs trust or buys it    | Decides whether "makadirio" wording stays |
| T8 | <b>Forwarding</b>            | "If you got this, who would you send it to?"                    | The forward path, group names, who the hub person is | Distribution and acquisition cost         |

**Rules for watching:** do not touch the phone, do not explain the screen, do not rescue him, never ask "is it easy?" When he gets stuck, write down exactly where, and only then help.

## 6. Notes: what counts as evidence (write this way)

One writer, one notebook, and one discipline: **verbatim, in his language, with numbers**. Never your summary. If you are writing "he was happy with the idea", you have written nothing.

Tag every note as you write it, so the analysis is mechanical:

| Tag           | Means                                  | Example                                              |
|---------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| FACT          | what he did, where, when               | "Walked to Kipsing, 2.5 hrs, pump was broken"        |
| NUMBER        | money, distance, time, animals, litres | "Paid 3,500 for acaricide; lost 4 shoats"            |
| QUOTE         | his exact words, translated literally  | "Nilipoteza siku nzima, mifugo ilikauka"             |
| WORKAROUND    | what he does instead of a service      | "Sends a boy ahead to look before moving the herd"   |
| PAYMENT       | anything he has actually paid for      | "50/= a month on data, 200/= to the vet for a visit" |
| TRUST - BREAK | a time advice failed him               | "The radio said rain; we moved and it did not come"  |
| COMMITMENT    | something he agreed to do, with a date | "Will bring 5 neighbours on Saturday"                |
| BLOCKER       | what stops him acting on advice        | "No money for drugs even when told early"            |

**After every interview, before the next one (20 minutes, same day):**

1. Write the **three-sentence story**: who he is, the one problem that mattered most, and what he does about it today.
2. List the numbers you got. Fewer than three numbers means the interview was too polite.
3. Mark each hypothesis in section 7 SUPPORTED / CONTRADICTED / UNKNOWN, with the quote or number that decided it.
4. Write down one thing we should **stop** believing.

## 7. The hypotheses, and what would prove us wrong

Each row is falsifiable. The right-hand column is the point: decide **in advance** what would change the product, so the decision is not made by the person who built it.

### Desirability — is this the problem?

| ID | Hypothesis                                                       | Question that tests it  | TRUE if                                                            | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                                                             |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D1 | The water and grazing decision is frequent, hard and expensive   | B4–B9, C10–C15, D16–D21 | ≥6/10 describe a specific episode with a month, a place and a cost | <4/10 can describe a specific loss → the problem is real but not acute enough to change behaviour |
| D2 | Information is the binding constraint — not money, water or land | C11–C12, E23–E26, H38   | They pay or travel to find out, and act on what they learn         | They know and still cannot act → we are optimising the wrong constraint                           |
| D3 | The loss is big enough to matter to a household                  | D19, H37, K52           | Named losses in animals, milk or shillings in the last 12 months   | Losses are rare and small → the willingness to change behaviour will be small too                 |
| D4 | It is a recurring decision, not once a year                      | B4, C10, D16            | Weekly-to-monthly cadence in ≥6/10                                 | Once a season → a weekly rhythm is the wrong product                                              |

### Usability — can he use it, unaided?

| ID | Hypothesis                                                    | Question that tests it | TRUE if                                                   | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                   |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| U1 | A herder can find and use a WhatsApp service without training | T1, T3, G36            | ≥7/10 complete the task unaided                           | ≤4/10 → complexity, not content, is the product risk    |
| U2 | One tap is a price he will pay to receive something           | T3, L54                | ≥6/10 report once, or agree to a test                     | Most refuse → redesign the reciprocity loop, or drop it |
| U3 | Voice beats text for the people who matter most               | T4, G35                | Voice is chosen by the least literate and the most remote | Text dominates → re-allocate our effort                 |

| ID | Hypothesis                                 | Question that tests it | TRUE if                                               | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                                  |
|----|--------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| U4 | Our messages are understood the first time | T2                     | ≥8/10 restate the advice correctly in their own words | Common misreadings → the wording is wrong even when the logic is right |

### Feasibility — can we stand behind it?

| ID | Hypothesis                                     | Question that tests it | TRUE if                                                             | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                                 |
|----|------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| F1 | A kg estimate is credible and useful           | T6                     | He has a reference weight and names a use (sale, dosing, condition) | No reference weights → weight stays shadow-only, and we say why       |
| F2 | Rain-onset language survives being wrong       | T7, I43                | He tolerates "estimate" wording and keeps using the service         | He punishes any miss → probability language only, never a countdown   |
| F3 | The map is readable, and its age is understood | T5                     | He finds his place and reads the date/"kadirio" correctly           | He reads the map as today's truth → harder age statement, or less map |

### Viability — who pays, and who lets us in?

| ID | Hypothesis                                                   | Question that tests it     | TRUE if                                             | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                                             |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| V1 | Somebody already pays for this kind of information           | H39, H40, informant guides | A named budget line or a real past payment exists   | Nobody → grant-dependent: decide whether that is acceptable <i>before</i> scaling |
| V2 | The herder pays something, however small                     | H39, H41                   | ≥4/10 already pay monthly for phone or vet services | 0/10 → herder-pays is off the table for now — say so publicly                     |
| V3 | The chief, the agrovet and the water committee will carry it | L55, L56, informant guides | ≥3 credible distribution offers, with names         | Nobody carries it → acquisition cost kills it                                     |
| V4 | No gatekeeper blocks it (politics, both herds, county turf)  | Informant guides, I45      | Nobody objects or claims ownership                  | A veto → negotiate, or change ward                                                |

### Impact — is the benefit where we claim it is?

| ID | Hypothesis                                                                      | Question that tests it | TRUE if                                                   | FALSE → kill/pivot if                                              |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I1 | Early information reaches the household, not only the herd owner                | K49–K52, G32           | Women and phone-sharers describe concrete household gains | The beneficiary never sees the message → the impact story is wrong |
| I2 | The measurable change is fewer wasted walks, less milk drop, fewer dead animals | C12, D19, K50          | Two or more are describable in numbers                    | Only "it feels useful" → unmeasurable, and unfundable              |

### What we assume about ourselves, stated so it can be attacked

| ID | What we assume                                                       | How this round could falsify it                                      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A1 | A pastoralist decides where to move, and is able to move             | The decision is collective, or the animals are held by a relative    |
| A2 | He wants advice from a phone more than he values his current sources | He trusts the chief or the radio, and says a phone cannot be checked |
| A3 | Our data is good enough to be useful at the decision moment          | He corrects most of what we show him, or the point data is too stale |
| A4 | We can reach him without an NGO or the county                        | Distribution needs a gatekeeper we do not yet have                   |

**Scoring sheet (fill one row per interview in the tracker spreadsheet):** record Y / N / ? for each hypothesis ID, plus the evidence ID (#4, #11...) that decided it. The tracker totals them and tells you the gate result in section 8.

## 8. Turning 10 conversations into a decision

### Same day, 20 minutes (do not skip this)

Write the three-sentence story, list the numbers, mark the hypotheses, note one thing to stop believing. Interviews blur together within a day — and the ones you did not debrief are the ones you will mis-remember in your own favour.

### Day 6–7: cluster, then count

Build this table from the notes. One row per problem, sorted by how many mentioned it **unprompted** — unprompted mentions are the only ones that count.

| Problem (in their words) | Unprompted /10 | What it costs today (their numbers) | What they do now | Does our product address it? | Verdict |
|--------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------|---------|
|--------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------|---------|

Then write, one sentence each:

1. **The problem statement, in their words.** Not ours. If it needs three sentences, it is three problems.
2. **Who is who** — section 2 completed, with real names and real roles.
3. **What we must not build** — the features this round would only have justified if the interviews had gone a different way.
4. **The one number that would change our mind** — written down before the next round.

## The decision gate

| Result                 | Condition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | What we do next                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>GO</b>              | ≥6/10 describe a specific, recurring, costly water or grazing decision <b>and</b> ≥6/10 have a phone/WhatsApp behaviour we can rely on <b>and</b> ≥5/10 name a real past payment for information or vet care <b>and</b> ≥4/10 accept a commitment | Keep the same loops; move to a 6-week pilot with 30 households in one ward, and measure the reciprocity test                                                   |
| <b>PIVOT — channel</b> | The problem is real, but the decision maker has no phone, or the phone holder does not decide                                                                                                                                                     | Change the entry point: voice notes to the phone holder, a signboard at the point, the agrovet as the front door, or the water committee as the account holder |
| <b>PIVOT — problem</b> | The pain is animal health, market price or water infrastructure, not grazing decisions                                                                                                                                                            | Re-plan around what they named: keep the platform, change the promise                                                                                          |
| <b>PIVOT — segment</b> | The pain is concentrated: only the far, large-herd households have it                                                                                                                                                                             | Narrow the segment on purpose; a broad launch spends money on the wrong people                                                                                 |
| <b>REFRA ME / STOP</b> | <4/10 can describe any specific loss with numbers in the last 12 months                                                                                                                                                                           | Stop building features. Test the problem again with a different segment, or a different problem                                                                |

## Seven ways to fool ourselves when analysing

1. **Counting prompted agreement as a mention.** "Yes, that happens too, sometimes" is not a mention.
2. **Averaging opinions.** Ten opinions are worthless; ten stories with numbers are data.
3. **Over-weighting the articulate.** The fluent English speaker is usually the most powerful herder in the ward, not the median user.
4. **Ignoring the woman's separate answer.** If she was not interviewed alone, you do not have her answer.
5. **Letting the chief choose the sample.** He will pick people like him.
6. **Treating our own registered users as market signal.** They already said yes.
7. **Falling in love with the demo.** A smooth demo in a manyatta proves only that we can drive our own product.

## 9. What we ship today, and the assumption under each piece

This is the round's most useful output: for every feature that exists, the belief it rests on and the evidence that would let us keep it. If a row ends with no evidence, either the feature is decoration or the interview guide is missing a question.

| Shipped service                            | What it rests on                                                                          | Questions that test it | Evidence that keeps it                                          | If false                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. MAJI — point status, queue, map</b>  | He goes to that point, and acts on a status that may be weeks old                         | C10–C15, T1, T3        | He reports one status, or uses one report to change a plan      | Drop the fan-out; keep only "is it worth walking to?"            |
| <b>One-tap water report</b>                | One tap is an acceptable price                                                            | T3, U2                 | ≥6/10 report once; some refuse openly                           | Redesign the loop, or pay in prestige (the contribution tally)   |
| <b>Queue length</b>                        | Queue time is decision input, not noise                                                   | C14, T2                | He asks about it, or misreads its absence                       | Remove the question: less to answer                              |
| <b>6. STATUS — build progress</b>          | He cares about the repair project and checks it                                           | C13                    | He asks about a specific point's repair                         | Stop it; it is a donor-facing feature                            |
| <b>2. PIN — register a point</b>           | He will do data entry for us                                                              | T1, L54                | He does it unaided, for a real point                            | Take the pin from a shared location, not a form                  |
| <b>10. KUPE NA MINYOO — pest window</b>    | He checks the animal when told where to look                                              | E22–E26, T2            | He describes a look he would not otherwise have done            | Keep it check-first and quieter, or fold it into the weekly note |
| <b>11. MALISHO YA LEO — grazing ledger</b> | Grazing place is chosen daily, a pin is possible, and energy/cost framing means something | B4–B9, D16–D21, T2     | He acts: a move, a "nimehamia", a corrected assumption          | Simplify to "is the grass better there?" and drop the units      |
| <b>8. MVUA — rain, dry spell, onset</b>    | Onset news changes a movement, and he tolerates "estimate"                                | B4, I42–I43, T7        | He names a decision it would change, and does not punish a miss | Report only what is observed; never a countdown                  |

| Shipped service                             | What it rests on                                                          | Questions that test it | Evidence that keeps it                                             | If false                                             |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Weekly note + 5. MAP image</b>           | A weekly appointment, a recognisable picture, forwarded to the clan group | T5, T8, L55            | He reads on a rhythm; he forwards it; the date stamp is understood | Fix the picture, or drop it: no map nobody reads     |
| <b>3. WEIGHT, 4. HERD estimate</b>          | A kg number is credible and useful (sale, dosing)                         | T6                     | A reference weight exists, and a use is named                      | <b>Stays shadow-only.</b> This is the current gate   |
| <b>7. SAUTI — voice replies</b>             | Voice beats text for the core user                                        | T4, G35                | The least literate and the farthest choose voice                   | Re-allocate effort to text                           |
| <b>Free-text questions ("ask anything")</b> | He asks in his own words, not through a menu                              | T1, G36, L54           | He asks an unscripted question, and it lands                       | Strengthen the menu; chat becomes the secondary path |
| <b>Place names ("nipo Kipsing")</b>         | Landmarks are how he locates himself                                      | T5, B4                 | He names a place we can resolve                                    | Fall back to a map pin                               |
| <b>Zero-install WhatsApp</b>                | WhatsApp is near-universal here, and data cost is acceptable              | G32–G35, H39           | SIM, WhatsApp and a data habit in ≥8/10                            | An SMS/USSD path, or a different front end           |

### Two rules for reading this table

- A feature whose evidence column is still empty after ten interviews is a liability: it costs attention and buys nothing.
- A feature whose evidence is **contradicted** is not a failed round. It is the round doing its job.

## 10. Ethics, consent and data protection (Kenya DPA 2019)

We are asking people to give us their time and their knowledge, in a context where "NGO" has a history. These rules are not decoration.

### Ask before you start, out loud, in his language (full script in Appendix A):

- Who we are and what we are doing (research, not the county, not a relief programme).
- That this is voluntary, that he can stop or skip anything, and that saying no has no consequence for him with anyone.
- That we want to write down and record what he says, that we will use it to decide what to build, and that we will not use his name in anything we publish without asking.
- That there is **no payment** for this today, and that we may not build anything at all.
- Then: "May we start? Are you comfortable with the recorder on?"

### What we never do in the field

| Never                                                                                    | Because                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Give animal-health advice, a diagnosis, or a drug name                                   | That is the vet's and the agrovet's role; we are not there to practise |
| Promise water projects, jobs, handouts, cash, airtime, or that the service will continue | Creates expectations we cannot meet and biases every later answer      |
| Quote him by name without explicit permission                                            | Trust and, under the DPA, personal data                                |
| Photograph him, his home, his animals or his documents without a clear yes               | Private space, and no photo is worth losing the relationship           |
| Interview children, or ask about conflict, land or ethnic politics                       | Out of scope and unsafe                                                |
| Discuss his household money in front of others if it visibly causes friction             | The woman's answer must not cost her anything                          |

### If he asks for something we cannot give (a pump repair, drugs, a lift):

*"I cannot fix that, and I am not the county. What I can do is write down exactly what you told me, and if you want, I can tell you who to call. Should we do that?"*

Then note it as BLOCKER evidence. Those asks are the most valuable thing in the interview — they show the real gap.

### Data handling

| Item           | Rule                                                                                                                   |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Consent        | Verbal, recorded or noted, with the date and the person's initials                                                     |
| Names          | Initials or a number in the tracker; full names only in the paper notebook, stored with the kit, not on a shared drive |
| Recordings     | Kept locally, deleted after transcription (target: 30 days)                                                            |
| Transcription  | Verbatim quotes only; the audio is not the deliverable                                                                 |
| Sharing        | Findings shared anonymised; no quotes with a name unless permitted                                                     |
| His rights     | Tell him he can ask us to delete what he said, and honour it                                                           |
| Sensitive data | None: no health data about him, no financial account details, no ID numbers                                            |

## 11. Plan, kit and budget

Ten working days, two people.

| Day      | What happens                                                                                                  | Output                                                     |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1        | Courtesy calls: chief, agrovet, water committee. Explain, get permission, recruit the first four by screening | 4 booked, local protocol respected                         |
| 2–4      | 2 pastoralist interviews per day (morning at the manyatta, late afternoon at the water point)                 | 6 interviews + same-day debriefs                           |
| 5        | Rest/analysis day: cluster what we have, revise questions that are not working                                | Mid-round note: what is already clear, what is still blank |
| 6–8      | 4 more interviews, deliberately filling the emptiest quotas (women, the far, the non-WhatsApp)                | 10 interviews, quotas met                                  |
| 9        | The 5 ecosystem informants (agrovet, vet, chief, water committee, NDMA/CBO)                                   | Who pays, who blocks, who distributes                      |
| 10       | Two follow-ups and the commitment asks (a test at the water point, introductions)                             | Commitments in writing; referrals                          |
| +2 weeks | Follow-up calls to the ones who accepted                                                                      | Retention signal without a pilot                           |

**Best times and places:** early morning at the manyatta (before the animals leave), late afternoon at the water point (people are already gathered, and the queue is visible), market day at the livestock market, and the chief's baraza for the ecosystem conversations. Never during a funeral, a wedding, or a drought relief distribution.

### Kit list

- Two phones, both charged; power bank; **a spare SIM with data**; the live service number already saved and tested before travel.
- Printed: crib sheet (Mom Test rules), consent card, one interview sheet per interview, Appendix A Swahili guide, the ecosystem guides.
- Notebook and two pens (paper — not a phone — for verbatim notes), voice recorder (charged, with space), a stapler for the pack.
- Paper copies to show: the weekly image, one advisory message, the pest window, the map. Two copies of the image: one to leave with him.
- 10 leave-behind cards with the service number to share (this is the distribution test).
- Water, a hat, sunscreen; tea/soda money; a modest contingency.
- This document, and the tracker spreadsheet on the laptop (for the evening debrief).

### Indicative budget (KSh, adjust to local rates; two people, 10 days)

| Line                                                                                      | Basis                            | Total           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|
| Transport / fuel                                                                          | 10 days, ward-to-ward, 1 vehicle | 20,000          |
| Field per-diem (team)                                                                     | 2 people × 10 days               | 30,000          |
| Tea / sodas / water for hosts                                                             | 15 visits, modest                | 4,500           |
| Airtime and data (team, for the live tests)                                               | 2 phones × 10 days               | 2,000           |
| Printing (crib sheets, consent cards, 15 interview sheets, images, 10 leave-behind cards) | one print run                    | 3,000           |
| Contingency (breakdown, extra trip, replacement)                                          | 15%                              | 9,000           |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                              |                                  | <b>≈ 68,500</b> |
| Payments to participants                                                                  | 0 — tea only, by policy          | 0               |

### Briefing a translator (Borana, Somali, Turkana speakers)

- Translate my question word for word. **Do not fix it, do not make it shorter, do not improve it** — a "better" question is usually a leading one.
- Never answer for him, and never nod along while he pauses.
- When he gives a number, repeat it back in Swahili and write it while he watches.
- Say nothing during the product tests. Your silence is the test.

## 12. Pre-mortem: how this round could still be a waste of time

Answer these before the fieldwork, then check them afterwards.

| Way it fails                                                                     | The early signal                                                   | What we would do                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| We interview the wrong people (the chief's friends, the fluent English speakers) | The sample is all men, all literate, all WhatsApp users            | Re-run with the quotas enforced: the missing voices carry the answers               |
| We get polite agreement instead of pain                                          | Notes are full of "they liked it", with almost no numbers          | Change the script: show nothing for the first 25 minutes                            |
| The problem is real but he cannot act on it                                      | He says he already knew, and did nothing                           | Our constraint theory is wrong: look at money, mobility, or the collective decision |
| The phone is not his at the moment of decision                                   | The phone is shared, or the animals are out with someone else      | Redesign around the real decision moment and the real phone holder                  |
| Our data cannot bear the claim at the decision moment                            | He corrects the map, the point status, the kg estimate             | Reduce the claim, show the age, or drop the artefact                                |
| Nobody pays                                                                      | No budget line surfaces anywhere, and no past payment exists       | Decide the model openly: grant, county, or a paid service to a different buyer      |
| A gatekeeper blocks us (politics, county turf, both-herd disputes)               | Someone asks why they were not consulted first, or claims the data | Negotiate formally — chief, ward, county — in writing                               |
| We learn a lot and change nothing                                                | No row in the decisions log with an owner and a date               | The round has failed: the log entry is the deliverable, not the notebook            |

**The decisions log** (one row per decision — the proof the round changed something):

| Decision | Evidence (interview #, quote or number) | Who owns it | By when |
|----------|-----------------------------------------|-------------|---------|
|          |                                         |             |         |

## Appendix A — Swahili spoken guide (what the interviewer actually holds)

### Kufungua (consent, 2 minutes)

*Habari. Jina langu ni \_\_\_\_, natoka Arda Link. Tunatengeneza huduma ya simu kwa wachungaji, na tunataka kujua matatizo yenu halisi. Hili ni mahojiano, si mradi wa msaada, na **hakuna malipo ya fedha**. Huenda tusitengeneze kitu kabisa. Nitakuuliza maswali kama dakika 45. Naomba kuandika na kurekodi, ili nisikose ulichosema. Unaweza kusimama, au kuruka swali lolote, wakati wowote. Tukianza?*

**Kumbuka kila wakati: omba namba.** "Siku ngapi? Kilometa ngapi? Shilingi ngapi? Wanyama wangapi? Lita ngapi? Saa ngapi?"

### A. Maisha ya kawaida

1. Niambie jana — kutoka ulipoamka hadi ulipolala. Ulifanya nini?
2. Nani alikuwa na mifugo jana? Walienda wapi?
3. Nani mwingine anaishi manyatta yako, na kila mmoja anafanya kazi gani?

### B. Uamuzi wa mwisho mgumu

1. Mara ya mwisho ulipohamisha mifugo, ilikuwa mwezi gani? Nini kilikufanya uamue?
2. Uliuliza nani? Kila mmoja alisema nini?
3. Ulichukua siku ngapi kuamua — kuanzia ulipofikiria hadi siku ya kuhama?
4. Ulijaribu nini kwanza, kabla ya kuhama?
5. Kuhama kulikugharimu nini — fedha, mifugo, siku, uhusiano?
6. Kulikuwa na wakati ulikaribia kwenda mahali pengine? Kwa nini hukwenda?

### C. Maji

1. Mara ya mwisho ulipofika maji na maji hayakuwa ya kutosha — chanzo gani, mwezi gani, ulitembea muda gani?
2. Ulifanya nini siku hiyo? Ulienda mahali pengine? Umbali gani?
3. Siku hiyo ilikugharimu nini — saa, fedha, mafuta, mifugo, hasira?
4. Kuna chanzo uliacha kwenda? Kwa nini?
5. Nani anakuambia kama maji yapo, au foleni ni ndefu? Unajuaje?
6. Uliwahi kulipa mtu kwa taarifa ya maji? Nini kilitokea?

### D. Malisho

1. Malisho karibu na maji yako yalikwisha lini? Mwezi gani?
2. Ulijuaje yamekwisha — nani aliona, na aliona nini?
3. Ulifanya nini baada ya hapo? Nani alikushauri? Ilifanikiwa?
4. Ulipoteza mifugo mingapi, au maziwa kiasi gani, katika kipindi hicho?
5. Kuna mtu anakuambia mapema mahali malisho yapo? Nani, mara ngapi?
6. Uliwahi kulipa kwa taarifa ya malisho — simu, usafiri kwenda kuangalia, zawadi?

#### **E. Kupe, minyoo na afya**

1. Mara ya mwisho ulipoona kupe au minyoo, ilikuwa mwezi gani?
2. Ulifanya nini kwanza? Uliuliza nani?
3. Ulinunua nini, kwa nani, bei gani? Ilisaidia?
4. Nani alikuambia uangalie mifugo — au uliona mwenyewe?
5. Kama ungeambiwa mapema kwamba hali ya kupe inaandaa, ungefanya nini tofauti? (Tambua: mara ya mwisho ulifanya nini?)

#### **F. Habari za sasa**

1. Habari za mvua na malisho unazipata wapi? Redio, chief, majirani, kikundi cha WhatsApp, daktari wa mifugo? Kipi kwanza?
2. Kipi kimewahi kukosea na kikakugharimu? Nini kilitokea?
3. Uliamini nini wiki iliyopita ambacho hakikuwa kweli? Uligundua vipi?
4. Mwezi wa kawaida unatumia kiasi gani kwa airtime na bundle?
5. Uko kwenye kikundi cha WhatsApp cha wachungaji? Wangapi? Kinaitwaje? Nani anasambaza kwa nani? (Kama akikubali, angalia.)

#### **G. Simu yenyewe**

1. Simu hii ni ya nani? SIM ngapi? Nani mwingine anaitumia?
2. Mara ya mwisho hamna mtandao malishoni, ilikuwa lini? Kwa muda gani?
3. Unachaji wapi? Betri ikikwisha, unafanya nini?
4. Unasoma kwa raha? Unasoma ujumbe, au unasikiliza sauti?
5. Nionyeshe unafanya nini ukipata ujumbe usioelewa. (Angalia tu — usimsaidie.)

#### **H. Fedha**

1. Mwezi uliopita ulitumia kiasi gani kwa mifugo — dawa, maji, usafiri, chakula, vet?
2. Ukiitaji shilingi 5,000 haraka, unauza nini, au unampigia nani?
3. Uliwahi kununua bundle, au huduma ya SMS, au kubeti? Kiasi gani kwa mwezi?
4. Uliwahi kulipa kwa ushauri — vet, agrovet, broker, mtu wa usafiri? Bei gani? Ilifaa?
5. Huduma kama hii ikileta habari za maji na malisho, nani huku kawaida hulipa kwa kitu kama hiki?

#### **I. Kuamini na kukosewa**

1. Niambie wakati ushauri kuhusu mifugo au mvua ulikosea. Ulifanya nini?
2. Simu ikikuambia mvua inakuja siku tano, kisha isinyeshe — utaifanyia nini simu hiyo?
3. Kuhusu mvua, unamwamini nani: chief, redio, vet, jirani, au ujumbe wa simu? Kwa nini?
4. Nini kitakufanya uache kuamini huduma kama hii kabisa?
5. Huduma ikisema "hatujui", ni bora au mbaya kuliko kubahatisha?

#### **J. Wengine walijaribu**

1. Mashirika gani yamewahi kuwapa taarifa au huduma kama hizi — NGO, county, redio, kanisa, bima? Nini kilitokea? Inaendelea?
2. Kwa nini kiliisha — au nini kingekufanya uendelee kuitumia?

#### **K. Nyumbani**

1. Unapopata taarifa mapema, nani ananufaika kwanza nyumbani, na anapata nini?
2. Nani anachota maji na kunywesha mbuzi? Kutembea kunabadilikaje kwa misimu?
3. Nani anaamua kuhusu mbuzi na kondoo, na fedha za maziwa?
4. Nyumbani kwako kungebadilika nini kama hutapoteza safari hata moja kwa maji mwaka huu? Hiyo ni thamani ya kiasi gani kwako?

#### **L. Omba kitu**

1. Naweza kurudi au kukupigia baada ya wiki mbili?
2. Unaweza kunionyesha simu yako, nitume ujumbe mmoja sasa, nawe ukiangalia?
3. Ni nani mwingine ninayepaswa kuongea naye — na **nani hatakubaliana** nawe?
4. Tunaweza kufanya jaribio kwenye chanzo chako cha maji, pamoja na kamati?
5. Nimekosea nini leo? Nilipaswa kuuliza nini, na sikuuliza?

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## **Appendix B — Per-interview sheet (one per interview; also in the print pack)**

**Header** — Date · Time start/end · Place (manyatta / water point / market) · Ward · Interviewer + writer · Consent given (Y/N) · Recorder on (Y/N) · Interview # (01–10)

**Who he is** — Initials · Sex · Approx age band · Language · Household size · Who holds the phone · Phone type / WhatsApp (Y/N) · Reads or listens · Species kept and rough counts · Main water point + walk time · Distance band from water (near/mid/far) · Recent move (Y/N, which month)

**Screening answers** (1–5), and **which quota he fills** (woman / far / camel / shoats / WhatsApp / shares a phone / bad health event)

**The three-sentence story** — written before you leave the chair

**Quotes** — verbatim, each tagged with its section letter (A–L)

**Numbers** — at least three; then copy them into the tracker's Numbers sheet

**Workarounds he uses today** — this is our real competitor list

**Payments he actually makes** — amount, to whom, for what, how often

**Trust-breaks** — a time advice failed him, and what he did about it

**Product tests** — T1 outcome · T2 misreadings · T3 report done? · T4 voice/text choice · T5 map verdict · T6 reference weight · T7 uncertainty reaction · T8 forward path

**Commitments** — what exactly, with a date · Who he will introduce us to · What he said we should not build

**Hypothesis verdicts** — for each of D1–D4, U1–U4, F1–F3, V1–V4, I1–I2, A1–A4: Y / N / ? plus the evidence id

**My one line to the team tonight**

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## Appendix C — Ecosystem informant guides (5 × 20–30 minutes)

These are not users. They tell us who pays, who blocks, who carries it, and what is already being paid for.

### C1. Agrovet (the counter, the cash and the trust)

1. What do herders come in and ask about most — and what did they ask yesterday?
2. Which products do they buy for ticks and worms, and what do those cost?
3. When a herder cannot pay, what happens? Do you keep a record, or credit?
4. Who tells them to come — a vet, the chief, a neighbour, or nobody?
5. How would customers hear about a phone service with early tick warnings: could it be printed here, or mentioned at the counter? (Past tense: has he ever carried anything like this before, and what happened?)
6. How many herders do you see in a week, and do they come on a rhythm?

### C2. County vet / sub-county livestock officer (authority and content)

1. What surveillance do you have, and where does it come from today?
2. What do you spend on data collection per month — people, fuel, airtime?
3. If a service gave you weekly ground truth on water points and pasture, would that replace or add to something you already pay for?
4. Which budget line would that come from, and when is it decided?
5. Whose wording do you want used for tick/worm messaging — and who signs it off?
6. What would make the county object to this service operating in the ward?

### C3. Chief / assistant chief (the gate)

1. How do you announce something to the ward, and when is the next baraza?
2. Who would you ask to test something like this — and who would you leave out? (That answer is his sampling bias: write it down.)
3. What has an NGO or the county promised this ward before, and what happened?
4. Would a signboard with a number at the water point work? Who maintains it?
5. What would make people distrust a service like this?

### C4. Water point committee / WRUA (the operators)

1. How do you learn that the pump is down, and how do you tell people today?
2. How many people use this point, and does the queue have a pattern by hour or day?
3. What do users contribute — cash, labour, livestock? How much, and when?

4. If the phone service reported a breakdown, what would you do differently?
5. Would the committee host a test here — and who has to agree?

### C5. NDMA ward officer / CBO project officer (data and money)

1. What ward-level data do you hold, how is it collected, and how old is it by the time you use it?
2. What do you pay for that collection, and from which line?
3. Where does our stream add something yours cannot give you?
4. What would you need to see before you put it into a budget or a proposal?
5. Who else in the ward should we be talking to — and who would disagree with this?

## Appendix D — Follow-up call, two weeks later (15 minutes)

The cheapest retention test we own. Call the ones who accepted.

1. Since we spoke, have you had to decide where to move, or where to water? What did you do?
2. Did anything we showed you change what you did? What, exactly?
3. Did you tell anyone about it? Who?
4. Did you look at the message again? How many times?
5. Would you still take my call in another two weeks?

**Interpretation:** something he did *without being asked* is the strongest signal available outside a pilot. "I forgot" is the honest answer and the most useful one — it means our service is not yet part of his rhythm.

## Appendix E — The tracker spreadsheet, and how this kit is generated

ArdaLink\_Mom\_Test\_Tracker.xlsx ships with this kit and is where every interview becomes a row. Sheets:

| Sheet            | What you do with it                                                                                                          |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01_Screener      | Book interviews: the five screening facts, which quota each one fills, and whether the sample still has gaps                 |
| 02_Hypotheses    | Every hypothesis with its falsification rule; score each interview Y / N / ? and record the evidence id                      |
| 03_Interview_Log | Date, place, duration, consent, recording, who was present, product-test outcomes                                            |
| 04_Quotes        | Verbatim quotes, tagged (FACT, NUMBER, QUOTE, WORKAROUND, PAYMENT, TRUST-BREAK, COMMITMENT, BLOCKER) with the section letter |
| 05_Numbers       | Every number he gave: item, value, unit, and which question it came from                                                     |
| 06_WhoIsWho      | The user / beneficiary / payer / gatekeeper map, completed with real names and roles                                         |
| 07_Gate          | Automatic totals: mentions per problem, hypothesis support, and the GO / PIVOT / STOP verdict                                |

The same content also lives as markdown in the repository (docs/field/mom\_test\_field\_kit.md), which is the source of truth for the .docx and the .pdf. Edit the markdown, re-run the generator, and every format updates together — so the questions asked in the field can never quietly drift from the questions we agreed on.

### Before the first interview, three things

1. Fill the sample quotas in 01\_Screener with names from the chief, the agrovet and the water committee.
2. Print the pack: crib sheet, consent cards, 15 interview sheets, the Swahili guide and the five informant guides.
3. Send one real message from your own phone into the live service. The number, the message and the flow you intend to show must be tested *before* you are sitting in front of a herder with one bar of network.